

AQL Sampling and Final Inspection

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Purpose and scope

This procedure defines how finished garment lots are sampled and judged before they are released to packing. It applies to every production order on LINE-001 through LINE-004 and to every SKU in the product master.

Inspection uses ISO 2859-1 General Inspection Level II with an Acceptable Quality Limit of 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects. Critical defects carry an AQL of zero: a single critical defect fails the lot.

Sample size by lot size

The sample is drawn from cartons already packed, spread across all cartons in the lot, never from a single carton.

Lot size (units)	Sample size	Accept (major)	Reject (major)
501 to 1,200	80	5	6
1,201 to 3,200	125	7	8
3,201 to 10,000	200	10	11
10,001 to 35,000	315	14	15

A 4,000 unit order therefore requires a 200 piece sample and is accepted at up to 10 major defects. An order of 10,000 units moves into the 315 piece band.

Inspection timing

Final inspection begins only when at least 80 percent of the lot is packed. Inspecting earlier produces a sample that is not representative because the early cartons come from the line's learning curve.

Allow one full working day for final inspection of lots above 3,200 units and half a day below that. This time sits after the last sewing day and must be included when a delivery date is promised.

Failed lots

A rejected lot is returned to the line for 100 percent re-inspection and rework. Re-inspection of a failed lot requires a fresh sample at the next stricter level, and the lot cannot be re-offered on the same day it failed.

Plan a minimum of two additional working days whenever a lot fails. Where the order is already at risk on capacity, a failed lot should be escalated to the merchandiser before rework begins, because a revised delivery date is usually cheaper than overtime rework.